

User Stories

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Context & Objectives

This document defines user stories for the Sua Hair Studio booking system across three user personas: Clients who book appointments, Stylists who are employed at the salon, and the Owner who manages the business. Stories are organised into sections per user and follow the format: As a [role], I want to [goal], so that [benefit].

Design Principle: Luxury

Every interaction — from the first tap on the booking calendar to the post booking confirmation should feel considered, warm, and premium. Sua Hair Studio positions itself as a luxury salon. The system must reflect that: refined copy, personalised recognition of returning clients, elegant empty states, and no generic UI patterns that make the experience feel transactional.

User Personas

Client (Guest / Public)

A salon customer, typically a woman aged 20–50 based in Melbourne. She books on her phone between other activities and expects the process to take under 2 minutes. She does not create an account. Her core needs: see real availability, choose a preferred stylist, know the price upfront, feel remembered if she has booked before, and receive a confirmation that reinforces the salon's premium brand.

Stylist / Employee (Authenticated Read Only)

A stylist employed at Sua Hair. She logs in with her own credentials to see her personal daily and weekly schedule, client notes, and new booking notifications. She has no access to the full owner dashboard, other stylists' schedules, or any write actions. Her core need is to be informed: know who is coming, when, and what they need so she can deliver a flawless service.

Owner (Authenticated Full Access)

Sua, the salon owner, or a designated senior manager. She accesses the full admin dashboard daily from desktop or tablet to manage all bookings, the salon schedule, stylist rosters, opening hours, and complex multi-phase services. She needs operational clarity and total control, including the ability to stagger break times, handle overtime, run sandwich bookings for long chemical treatments, and review every new booking as it comes in.

Business Objectives

Client goal: Enable a client to independently book a luxury hair appointment in under 2 minutes, on mobile, and feel valued from first tap to confirmation.

Stylist goal: Give each stylist a clear, personal view of their day so they can prepare and deliver exceptional service without needing to ask the owner for their schedule.

Owner goal: Give the salon owner total visibility and control: schedule, bookings, staff hours, breaks, and complex multi-phase services from a single dashboard.

System goal: Eliminate double bookings, reduce manual admin overhead, and surface the right information to the right person at the right time.

Key Scheduling Concepts

- Recurring Hours:** Salon wide weekly schedule sets the outer availability boundary for all stylists. Each stylist's working hours sit within that window.
- Date Overrides:** Owner can close the salon or set different hours on specific dates (public holidays, events) without changing the recurring schedule.
- Break Blocks:** Admin created blocks that mark a stylist as unavailable (e.g. lunch, rest). Staggered per stylist. Excluded from client availability automatically.
- Overtime / Buffer:** When a service runs over its booked time, the admin manages this manually on the timeline. The system makes overtime visible but does not auto push subsequent bookings.
- Multi-Phase Services:** Long treatments (e.g. perms, toners) involve Phase 1 (active application), a hands-off Processing Window (stylist free for a secondary client), and Phase 3 (active finish). The system handles this at booking time and alerts the owner before Phase 3 must begin.
- Waitlist:** When a date or stylist is fully booked, clients can join a waitlist. The owner sees waitlist entries in the dashboard and contacts clients directly when a slot opens.

Section A — Client Stories

User: Client (guest, unauthenticated) · 20 stories across 9 areas

ID	Story Title	Role	I want to...	So that...	Acceptance Criteria
— Stylist Selection —					
US C01	View all stylists	Client	See all stylists as selectable chips with photos	I can choose who to book with immediately	- Stylist chips show headshot, name, and tier level 'First Available' chip is shown as the default first option - Chips scroll horizontally on mobile without wrapping - Selected chip is highlighted with the brand gold colour - Only active stylists (isActive: true) are shown
US C02	Filter by First Available	Client	Select 'First Available' and have the calendar jump to the soonest open date	I don't need to manually browse to find when someone is free	'First Available' is selected by default on page load - Calendar auto highlights the nearest available date - Advances to the next month if the current month has no availability - Re selecting 'First Available' resets any specific stylist filter
US C03	Select a specific stylist	Client	Tap a stylist chip to filter availability to that person only	I can book with the stylist I prefer	- Selecting a chip deselects any previously selected chip - Calendar updates to show only that stylist's available days - Selected stylist photo and name carry through to the booking summary in Step 2
— Calendar Navigation —					
US C04	View a monthly calendar	Client	See a full month grid with dot indicators on open days	I can quickly scan which days have openings	- Full month grid with day of week headers is shown - Days with available slots display a subtle dot indicator - Past days are greyed out and not selectable

ID	Story Title	Role	I want to...	So that...	Acceptance Criteria
					• Today's date is visually distinguished • Current month and year are shown as the calendar heading
US C05	Navigate between months	Client	Tap previous/next arrows to move between calendar months	I can book an appointment in a future month	• Previous and next month arrow buttons are displayed • Previous arrow is disabled when viewing the current month • Navigating months refreshes the availability dots • The selected date is cleared when the month changes
US C06	Select a date	Client	Tap a date on the calendar to select it	I can see the available time slots for that day	• Tapping a date with availability highlights it as selected • Tapping a past or unavailable date has no effect • The time slot grid appears below the calendar after a date is selected • Previously selected slot and service are cleared when a new date is chosen
— Time Slot Selection —					
US C07	View available time slots	Client	See a grid of available time slots after selecting a date	I can pick a time that suits me	• Slots appear in a 4-column grid after a date is selected • Only unbooked, non-blocked slots are shown for the chosen stylist and date • Slots are listed in chronological order • A friendly message is shown if no slots are available for that combination • Times are displayed in 12-hour format (e.g. 10:00 AM)
US C08	Select a time slot	Client	Tap a time slot to select it	The service list and notes field appear so I can complete my selection	• Tapping a slot highlights it as selected • The service list animates in below after a slot is selected • The notes field appears after a slot is selected • Changing the selected slot clears any previously chosen service
— Service Selection —					
US C09	View services with prices	Client	See a list of all services with prices on the right	I know exactly what each service costs before committing	• Service name on the left, price on the right • Price reflects the selected stylist's tier (director / senior / junior) • If 'First Available' is selected, a price range (min–max) is displayed • The service list appears only after a time slot is selected • All active services are shown
US C10	Select a service	Client	Tap a service from the list to select it	I can confirm which treatment I want before entering my details	• Tapping a service highlights it as selected • Only one service can be selected at a time • The selected service and resolved price appear in the Step 2 summary • The 'Next' button activates once date, time, and service are all selected
— Notes —					
US C11	Add a note to my booking	Client	Type a free text note for the stylist	I can share context such as hair length,	• A notes text area appears after a time slot is selected • Placeholder hint text is shown (e.g. 'Any special requests for your stylist?')

ID	Story Title	Role	I want to...	So that...	Acceptance Criteria
				colour history, or special requests	• Notes are optional: the form can proceed without them • Notes are saved to the Firestore booking record and visible in the admin dashboard • 500-character limit with a live counter displayed when approaching the limit
— Progress & Navigation —					
US C12	See my progress through the flow	Client	See a step indicator at the top of the booking form	I know how many steps remain and where I am	• A 2-step indicator is shown: 'When & Who' and 'Your Details' • Step 1 is active while on BookingCalendar • Step 2 becomes active when the client proceeds • The indicator is visible on both mobile and desktop
US C13	Proceed to Step 2	Client	Tap a 'Next' button that enables only once all three selections are made	I move to entering my details only when my booking is fully chosen	• 'Next' is disabled until date, time slot, and service are all selected • The button becomes active when all three are chosen • Clicking 'Next' navigates to Step 2 without losing any selections • A booking summary (stylist, date, time, service, price) is shown at the top of Step 2
— Luxury Client Experience —					
US C14	Receive a luxury booking confirmation	Client	See an elegant confirmation screen immediately after booking	I feel confident my appointment is secured and I leave with a premium impression of the salon	• A full screen confirmation view is shown after booking is submitted • Displays stylist name and photo, service, date, time, and total price • Copy is warm and personal (e.g. 'We look forward to seeing you, Sarah') • A prompt to save the date to calendar is offered • Design reflects the salon's premium aesthetic no generic confirmation page
US C15	Receive an appointment reminder	Client	Receive an in app or on-screen reminder before my appointment	I don't forget my booking and I arrive prepared	• A reminder is shown when the client returns to the booking page near their appointment date • Reminder displays stylist, service, date, and time • The reminder includes a 'View or manage booking' option • Tone is warm and anticipatory, not transactional
US C16	Be recognised as a returning client	Client	Have the system recognise my phone number when I re book	I don't have to re-enter my name and details every time, and I feel remembered	• Phone number lookup on Step 2 matches existing client records • If a match is found, name and details prefill automatically • A subtle personalised greeting is shown (e.g. 'Welcome back, Sarah') • New clients experience the same flow no account creation required • Client details can be corrected before submitting if anything has changed
US C17	Join a waitlist when fully booked	Client	Add myself to a waitlist for a date or stylist that is fully booked	I don't lose the chance to get an appointment if a cancellation opens	• When no slots are available for a chosen date/stylist, a 'Join Waitlist' option is shown • Client enters their name and phone number to join • Waitlist position is confirmed on screen with elegant copy • Admin is notified of a new waitlist entry in their dashboard • Waitlist is visible in the admin booking management view
— Performance & Loading —					

ID	Story Title	Role	I want to...	So that...	Acceptance Criteria
US C18	Experience fast load on repeat visits	Client	Have stylist and service data load instantly on return visits	I don't wait for data to re fetch each time I open the booking page	• Stylist and service data cached in sessionStorage after first load • Repeat visits within the same session show no loading spinner for static data • Firestore IndexedDB persistence keeps the page functional through brief network drops • Availability (bookings) is always fetched fresh to ensure accuracy
US C19	See loading states while data fetches	Client	See skeleton loaders while the booking page is loading	The page feels intentional and polished, not broken, during the brief load	• Skeleton placeholders shown for stylist chips during load • Calendar skeleton shown until availability data is ready • Content loads progressively: no full-page blocking spinner • If a data fetch fails, a clear error message with a retry option is shown
— Mobile Responsiveness —					
US C20	Book comfortably from a phone	Client	Interact with all booking elements on a small screen	I can book while on the go without pinch zooming or excessive scrolling	• All tap targets meet the minimum 44px touch size • Stylist chips scroll horizontally without awkward wrapping • The calendar grid is fully visible on a 375px wide screen • Time slot grid collapses from 4 to 2 columns on screens narrower than 400px • No horizontal page scroll

Section B — Stylist / Employee Stories

User: Stylist (authenticated, read only personal view) · 7 stories across 3 areas

ID	Story Title	Role	I want to...	So that...	Acceptance Criteria
— Authentication & Access —					
US E01	Log in with stylist credentials	Stylist	Sign in with my own email and password to access my personal schedule view	I can see my upcoming bookings without accessing the full owner dashboard	• Stylist login page accepts email and password • Successful login routes to the stylist's personal schedule view (not the full admin dashboard) • Failed login shows a clear error without exposing other accounts • Session persists across page refreshes • Logout is accessible from the stylist view
US E02	See only my own schedule	Stylist	View a schedule that shows only my bookings, not my colleagues'	My day is clear and uncluttered by information that doesn't relate to me	• The stylist view shows only bookings assigned to the logged in stylist • No other stylists' bookings or personal details are visible • The owner's admin dashboard is not accessible from the stylist login • Read only: no edit, cancel, or create actions are available in this view
— Personal Schedule —					
US E03	View today's appointments	Stylist	See a clear list of all my bookings for today in time order	I can prepare for each client and manage my day	• Today's bookings are shown in chronological order • Each booking shows: client name, service, start time, duration, and any client notes • Current and upcoming appointments are visually distinguished • If I have no bookings today, a clear empty state is shown • The view refreshes automatically if a new booking is added mid-day
US E04	View my upcoming week	Stylist	See my bookings for the next 7 days immediately	I can plan and know when I'm busy	• A weekly view shows all my bookings across the next 7 days • Each day shows booking count and a list of appointments • I can tap a day to expand and see full booking details • Days where I'm not rostered are clearly indicated
US E05	See client notes before an appointment	Stylist	View any notes a client left when they booked	I can prepare the right products and approach before the client arrives	• Client notes are prominently displayed on each booking card • Notes are visible before the appointment time, not just during • If a client has no notes, the field is absent (not blank) • I cannot edit client notes from the stylist view
— Notifications —					
US E06	Receive a notification when a new booking is made for me	Stylist	See an in-app notification when a client books an appointment with me	I know immediately when my schedule has changed without refreshing manually	• A notification badge or banner appears in my view when a new booking is made for me • Notification shows client name, service, date, and time • Notification is dismissible after I've reviewed it • Notifications persist until dismissed: I don't miss them if I'm mid task

ID	Story Title	Role	I want to...	So that...	Acceptance Criteria
					• Multiple new bookings stack as separate notifications
US E07	Review a new booking assigned to me	Stylist	Tap a notification to open the full details of a new booking	I can review what the client has requested and prepare accordingly	• Tapping a notification opens the full booking detail view • Detail shows: client name, phone, service, date, time, duration, price tier, and notes • Detail view is read only: I can review but not modify the booking • I can dismiss the notification from within the detail view

Section C — Owner Stories

User: Owner / Admin (authenticated, full access) · 14 stories across 5 areas

ID	Story Title	Role	I want to...	So that...	Acceptance Criteria
— Opening Hours Management —					
US O01	Set recurring weekly salon hours	Owner	Define the salon's standard opening hours for each day of the week	Client facing availability is automatically bounded by when the salon is open	- Owner can set open/close time for each day of the week (Mon–Sun) - Days can be toggled as open or closed (e.g. closed Sundays) - Weekly schedule saves as the recurring default - Client facing booking calendar only shows slots within these hours - Changes take effect from the next calendar day (no retroactive impact on existing bookings)
US O02	Override hours for a specific date	Owner	Change the opening hours or close the salon entirely on a specific date	I can manage public holidays, special events, or unexpected closures without changing the recurring schedule	- Owner can select any future date and set custom hours or mark it as closed - Override appears distinctly on the admin schedule (e.g. flagged as 'special hours' or 'closed') - Overridden dates suppress normal availability for all stylists - Client facing calendar reflects the override: no slots shown on closed dates - Override can be removed to restore the recurring default
US O03	Set per stylist working hours	Owner	Define individual working hours for each stylist within the salon's open window	A stylist who works Tuesday–Saturday doesn't show as available on Monday	- Owner can set each stylist's working days and start/end times - Stylist hours cannot extend beyond salon opening hours - Stylist availability on the client facing booking page reflects their individual hours - Changes apply from the next calendar day - Owner can view all stylists' weekly schedules side by side
US O04	Block off stylist break times	Owner	Add break blocks to a specific stylist's schedule at any time on any day	I can stagger lunch breaks across stylists, and the system won't offer those slots to clients	- Owner can add a break block to any stylist on any day from the admin timeline - Break blocks can be set with custom start time and duration - Break blocks are excluded from client facing availability automatically - Different stylists can have breaks at different times on the same day - Break blocks can be edited or removed by the owner
— Notifications & Booking Review —					
US O05	Receive a notification for every new booking	Owner	See an in-app notification immediately whenever a client makes a new booking	I stay in control of what's coming into the salon and can act quickly if needed	- A notification badge appears in the admin dashboard when a new booking is made - Notification shows client name, service, stylist, date, and time - Multiple new bookings stack as individual notifications - All notifications are visible in a dedicated notifications panel - Notifications remain until dismissed: they do not auto clear
US O06	Review a new booking in full	Owner	Click a notification to open the complete details of any new booking	I can verify the booking is correct and have all the information I need to act on it	- Clicking a notification opens the full booking detail modal - Detail shows: client name, phone, service, stylist assigned, date, time, duration, price, and any notes

ID	Story Title	Role	I want to...	So that...	Acceptance Criteria
					• Owner can edit booking details (stylist, time, service) from the modal • Owner can cancel the booking from the modal with a confirmation step • Dismissed notification is marked as reviewed
— Schedule & Timeline —					
US O07	View the full salon schedule on the timeline	Owner	See all stylists' bookings displayed side by side on a time-based daily timeline	I can see immediately who is busy, who is free, and where gaps exist across the whole salon	• Each stylist is displayed as a vertical column on the timeline • Bookings appear as colour coded blocks at the correct time position • A red line moves in real time to show the current time • The timeline spans the salon's opening hours for the selected date • Multi phase service bookings are visually distinguished with phase indicators
US O08	See when a booking is running over time	Owner	See a visual indicator on the timeline when a booking has exceeded its booked duration	I know which chair is running late so I can manage the next client's expectations	• Blocks that have passed their scheduled end time show an overtime indicator (colour change or stripe) • Overtime duration is shown on the block (e.g. '+12 min') • The timeline does not auto push subsequent bookings: the owner manages this manually • The assigned stylist's next booking is visually flagged if overtime creates a risk of conflict
— Multi Phase Services (Sandwich Bookings) —					
US O09	Create a multi-phase service booking	Owner	Book a service with an active application phase, a hands-off processing phase, and an active finish phase	I can take a secondary client during the processing window and maximise each stylist's time	• Owner selects a service flagged as multi-phase (e.g. Perm, Toner, Treatment) • System prompts for Phase 1 duration, processing duration, and Phase 3 duration • Three blocks are created on the timeline: Phase 1 (active), Processing (hands off, distinct colour), Phase 3 (active) • The processing window is opened for secondary bookings in the admin view • Client facing booking does not expose processing window slots: admin only
US O10	Take a secondary booking during a processing window	Owner	Assign a second client to a stylist during their active treatment's processing window	I can maximise stylist revenue without creating conflicts	• Processing window slots are available for new bookings in the admin timeline only • Secondary booking is constrained to end before Phase 3 of the original booking begins • System warns the owner if a secondary booking risks overlapping with Phase 3 • Secondary booking appears as a distinct block inside the processing window on the timeline
US O11	Receive a Phase 3 reminder	Owner	Get an in-app alert when a multi-phase treatment's processing window is almost over	The stylist returns to the client on time, and the treatment is completed correctly	• A countdown timer is shown on the processing block as Phase 3 approaches • An in-app notification fires 5 minutes before Phase 3 is due to begin • Notification displays: client name, service, stylist, and the time Phase 3 must start • The notification is dismissible once acknowledged • The timer is visible on the timeline block itself for at a glance awareness
— Booking Management —					

ID	Story Title	Role	I want to...	So that...	Acceptance Criteria
US O12	Create a manual booking (walk in or phone)	Owner	Create a booking directly from the admin dashboard on behalf of a client	I can handle walk ins and phone enquiries without asking the client to book online	• Owner can open a create booking modal from the timeline or bookings list • All booking fields match the client facing flow: stylist, date, time, service, client details • Manual bookings appear on the timeline immediately and trigger a stylist notification • Owner can mark a booking as 'walk in' for reporting purposes
US O13	Search and filter all bookings	Owner	Search bookings by client name or phone number, and filter by date range and stylist	I can find any booking quickly without scrolling through the full list	• Search bar filters bookings in real time as the owner types • Filter by date range: today, this week, or custom • Filter by stylist • Results show booking status, service, date, and time • An empty state is shown clearly when no results match
US O14	View and manage the waitlist	Owner	See all clients who have joined the waitlist for a fully booked date or stylist	I can contact them when a slot opens and convert a missed booking into revenue	• A waitlist view is accessible from the admin dashboard • Each waitlist entry shows client name, phone, requested stylist (if specified), and date joined • Owner can contact the client directly using the displayed phone number • Owner can mark a waitlist entry as contacted or remove it once resolved • Waitlist entries are ordered by date added (oldest first)